

question formation

- 1 How long **have you** been waiting? How many children **does your sister** have? **Should we** buy her a present? 1.3
- 2 Why **didn't you** like the movie? **Isn't this** a beautiful place? **Don't you** have to be at school today?
- 3 What are you talking **about**? **Who** does this bag belong **to**?
- 4 **Who** lives in that house?
How many people **follow** you on Twitter?

- 1 We make questions with tenses where there is an auxiliary verb (be, have, etc.) and with modal verbs (should, must, etc.) by inverting the subject and the auxiliary / modal verb. With the simple present and past, we add the auxiliary verb do / does or did before the subject.
- 2 We often use negative questions to show surprise when we expect somebody to agree with us, or to check whether something is true.
- 3 If a verb is usually followed by a preposition, e.g., talk about something, the preposition comes at the end of the question, not at the beginning. **NOT** About what are you talking?
- We often just use the question word and the preposition, e.g., A I'm thinking. B What about?
- 4 When who / what / which, etc., is the **subject** of questions in the simple present or past, we **don't** use do / did, e.g., Who wrote this? **NOT** Who did write this?



Could you tell me **what time the store next door opens**? 1.4
Do you know **if (whether) Mark's coming to the meeting**?

- We use indirect questions when we want to ask a question in a more polite way. We begin with a phrase such as Can / Could you tell me...? Do you know...? Do you think...? Do you remember...? Would you mind telling me...? Do you have any idea...?
- Compare:
What time does the post office open? (direct question) and
Could you tell me what time the post office opens? (indirect question)
- In indirect questions, the order is subject + verb. Can you tell me where it is? **NOT** Can you tell me where is it?
- We don't use do / did in the second part of the question. Do you know where he lives? **NOT** ...where does he live?
- You can use if or whether in questions without a question word and after: Can you tell me, Do you know, etc.

Other expressions followed by the word order of indirect questions

The word order of indirect questions is used after:

I wonder..., e.g., I **wonder** why they didn't come.

I'm not sure..., e.g., I'm **not sure** what time it starts.

I can't remember..., e.g., I **can't remember** where I left my phone.

I'd like to know..., e.g., I'd **like to know** what time you're coming home.

a Order the words to make questions.

tomorrow can't Why come you ?

Why **can't you come tomorrow**?

- 1 I Should her tell I feel how ?
- 2 friend known long best have How you your ?
- 3 tell when you train next leaves the Could me ?
- 4 are What about you thinking ?
- 5 on do weekend you What doing the like ?
- 6 music to does What Junko kind like listening of ?
- 7 you time movie know finishes Do what the ?
- 8 class students yesterday to many came How ?
- 9 you remember is where Do the restaurant ?
- 10 housework family in Who your the does ?

b Complete the questions with the words in parentheses.

Where **did you go** on vacation last year? (you / go)

- 1 How often _____? (you / usually exercise)
- 2 Who _____ The Great Gatsby? (write)
- 3 Could you tell me how much _____? (this book / cost)
- 4 I can't remember where _____ my car this morning. (I / park)
- 5 _____ your trip to Paris last weekend? (you / enjoy)
- 6 What kind of work _____? (your sister / do)
- 7 Who _____ the last cookie? (eat)
- 8 Do you know what time _____ on Saturdays? (the swimming pool / open)
- 9 Why _____ the present you gave her? (your sister / not like)
- 10 _____ play your music so loud? I can't concentrate. (you / have to)